Northwind Traders — Employee Handbook (2026)

1. Working hours

Core hours are 10:00 to 16:00 local time, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours, staff may choose when they work, as long as they work 40 hours a week. Overtime must be approved in advance by a line manager and is paid at 1.5 times the normal hourly rate.

2. Remote work

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week after completing their probation period of 90 days. Fully remote arrangements need written approval from the department head. Northwind pays a home-office allowance of $40 per month to staff who work remotely at least two days a week.

3. Equipment

Every employee receives a laptop that is replaced every three years. A second monitor, keyboard and mouse can be claimed once, up to a total of $300. Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to IT within 24 hours.

Leave and absence

4. Annual leave

Full-time staff receive 22 days of paid annual leave plus public holidays. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over to the next year and must be used by 31 March. Leave requests of more than 5 consecutive days must be submitted at least 4 weeks in advance.

5. Sick leave

Staff receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A doctor's note is required for absences longer than 3 consecutive days. Sick leave cannot be carried over.

6. Parental leave

Primary caregivers receive 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave, and secondary caregivers receive 4 weeks. Parental leave can start up to 2 weeks before the expected birth or adoption date.

Expenses and travel

7. Expense claims

Expenses must be submitted through the finance portal within 30 days, with a receipt for every item above $25. Claims are reimbursed in the next monthly payroll.

8. Travel

Economy class is required for flights under 6 hours; premium economy is allowed for longer flights. The daily meal allowance while travelling is $60 in North America and Europe and $45 elsewhere. Hotels must be booked through the company travel tool.

9. Learning budget

Each employee has a learning budget of $1,000 per year for courses, books and conferences. Unused budget does not roll over. Requests above $500 need manager approval.